MultiMC on Dropbox / Multi OS

This guide shows you how to setup MultiMC on cloud storage, allowing you to run your favourite Minecraft games on multiple computers.

Settings can be tweaked manually when using a different OS. A Python script has been written to automate this process.

This tutorial uses Dropbox, Windows 11 and Linux Mint.
It is assumed you already have a working Dropbox installation on all the computers you want use.

If possible, start the process on Windows as there are mor files in the Windows version of MultiMC

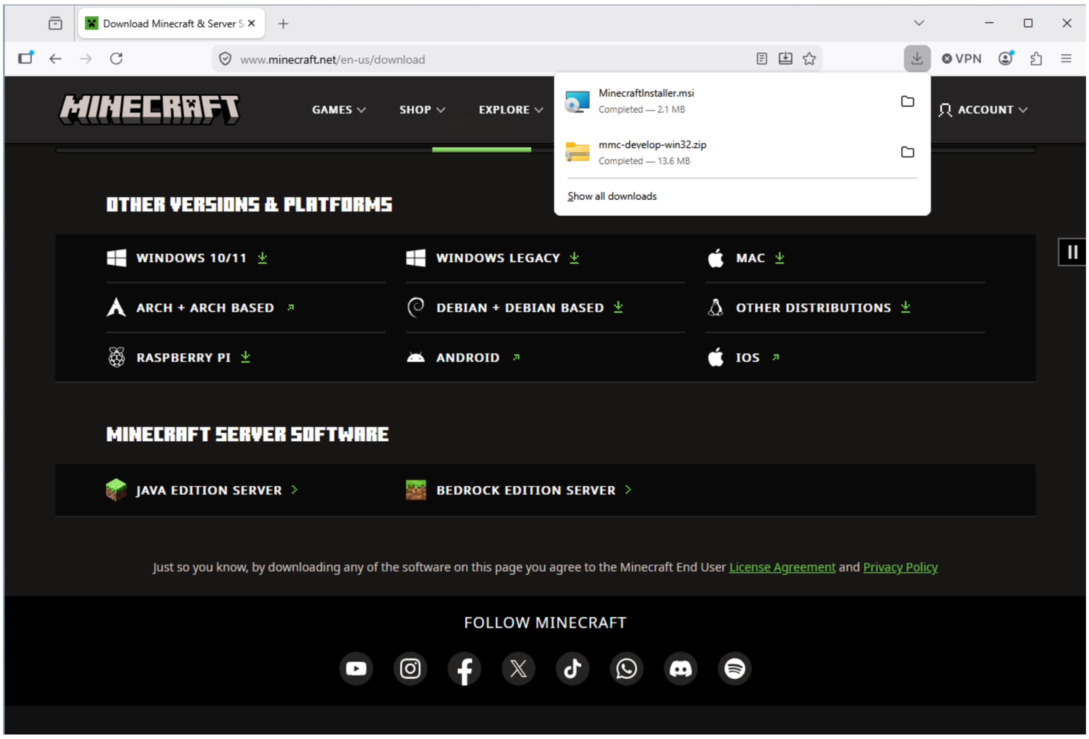
Setup Dropbox:

- Add a folder to Dropbox: “multimc”
- Add a folder within multimc: “java”
- Add 2 folders within multimc/java: “windows” and “linux”

Get minecraft:

www.minecraft.net/en-us/download

Click on “Looking for another version? See below”
Click on Windows legacy, which will download the msi

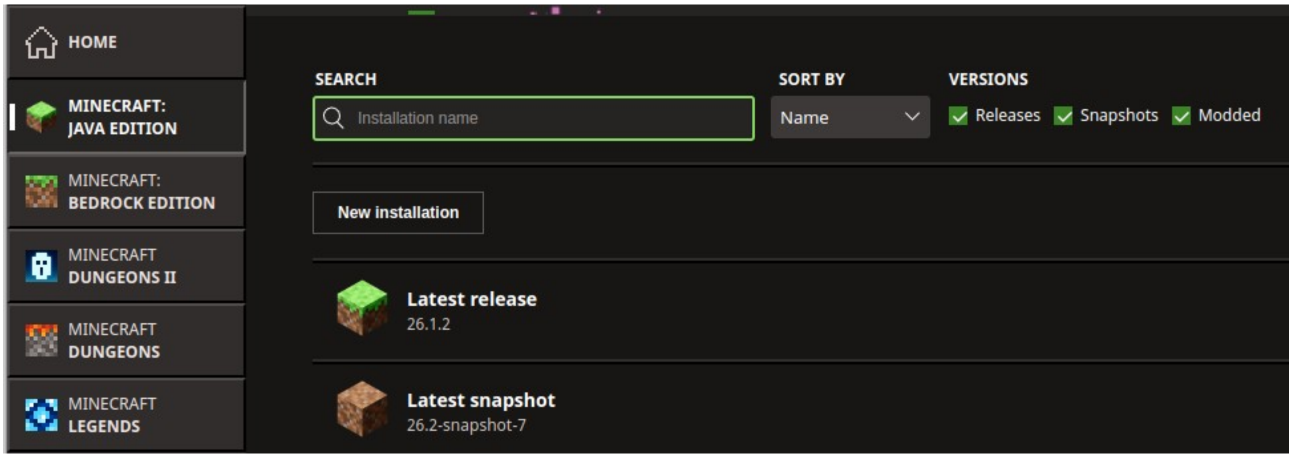


If you already have a Minecraft installation:

1. copy the folder `C:\Users\<your username>\AppData\Roaming\.minecraft` somewhere else for safekeeping.
2. un-install Minecraft. After re-install you can keep track of Java distributions used for each game, as they will appear here in the runtimes folder

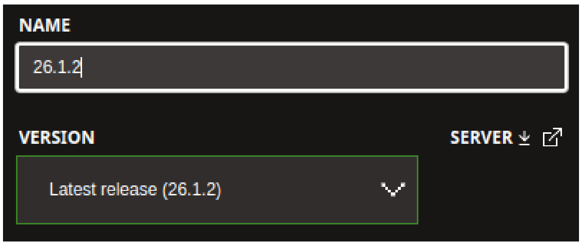
Run the downloaded file and install with all defaults to `C:\Program Files (x86)\Minecraft Launcher`

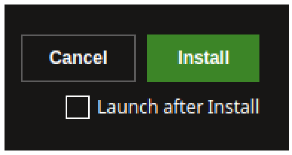
Finish the install and get to the “Sign in with Microsoft” prompt
Click the Minecraft: Java edition button
Click New Installation



Give the install a name.
Choose the version.

Un-tick “launch after install”
Click install





You are not going to be using this install, so don’t bother with mod loaders and mods. The purpose of doing this is to get the correct version of Java

I am choosing 26.1.2 as it is currently the latest release, and my favourite mod ccTweaked works with this version

After install go back to `C:\Program Files (x86)\Minecraft Launcher\`

There will be a new folder called runtime.
Click through this folder until you reach the final one, typically:

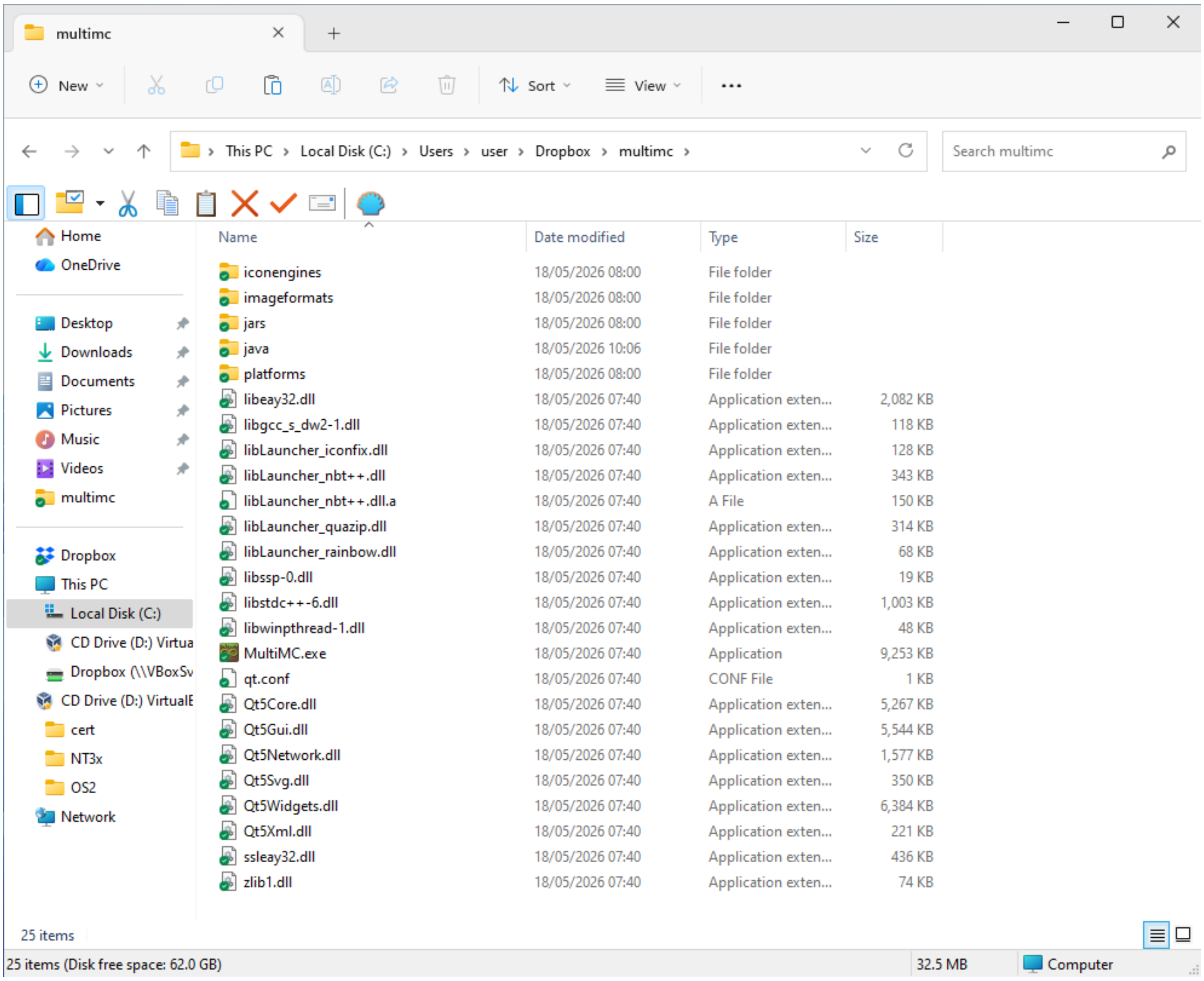
```
C:\Program Files (x86)\Minecraft Launcher\runtime\java-runtime-epsilon\windows-x64\java-runtime-epsilon
```

Copy this folder into `Dropbox/mutimc/java/windows/`

Get multimc from https://multimc.org/

Windows button downloads multimc-develop-win32.zip.
Unzips to a folder called MultiMC

Copy the folder contents to Dropbox\multimc

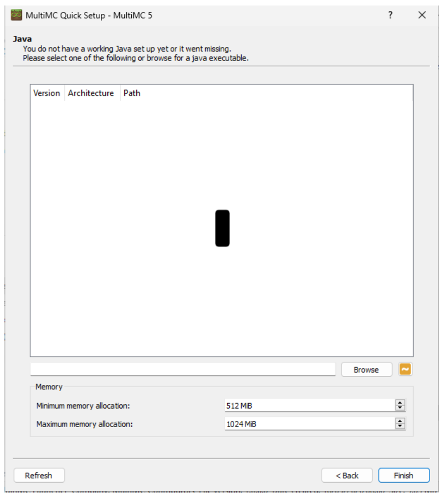


From the Dropbox\Multimc folder double-click on MultiMc.exe

You may get a Windows warning. Run anyway

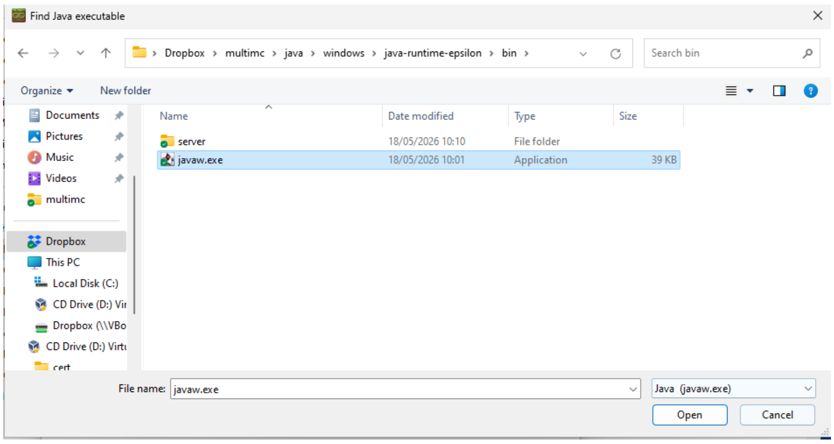
Select your language.
Next

It is complaining about not finding java
Click Browse



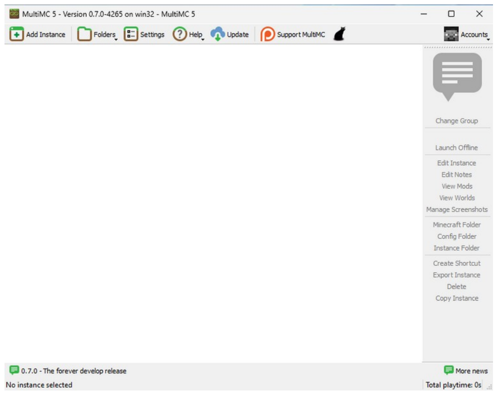
Navigate to your newly copied Java installation in

Dropbox/java/windows/<version>/bin/javaw.exe

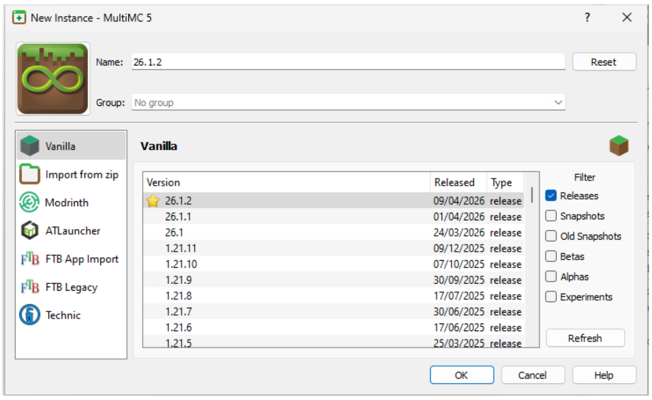


Click Finish

Click Add Instance



Choose the version you want and click ok



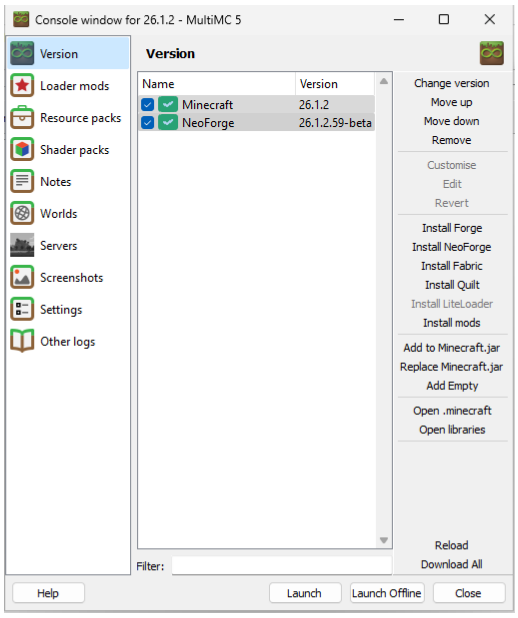
Click the Accounts button (top right) and login.
You only have to do this once.
You may have to restart MultiMC

Choose your account from the Accounts button

Click Edit Instance on your selected game

You can choose your mod loader resource packs etc .from here.

For full instructions visit MultiMC website.



Click Settings

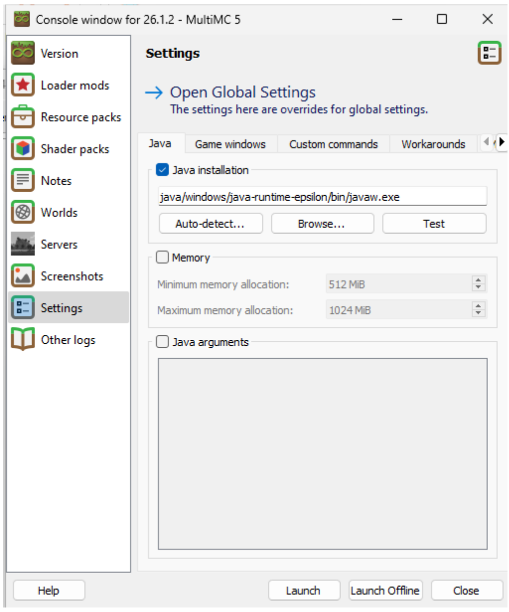
Click Java Installation

It should use the same one as you selected earlier

Click Test to confirm it is working

Close dialogs until you reach the home page and launch your game.

It will probably fail the first time, try again.

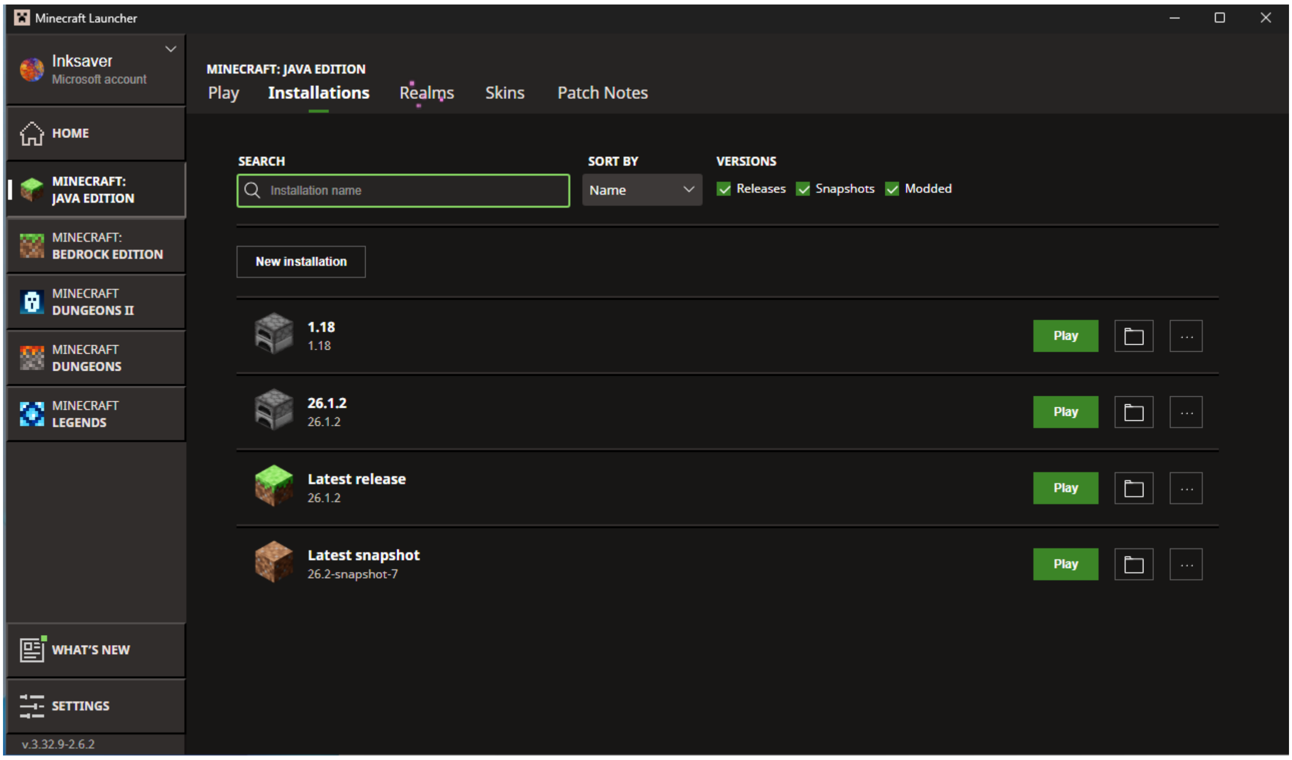


If you are trying this on a VirtualBox VM it will not run due to OpenGL

Go to https://fdossena.com/?p=mesa/index.frag and download the opengl32.dll file into the java/bin installation you are using for the selected minecraft game.

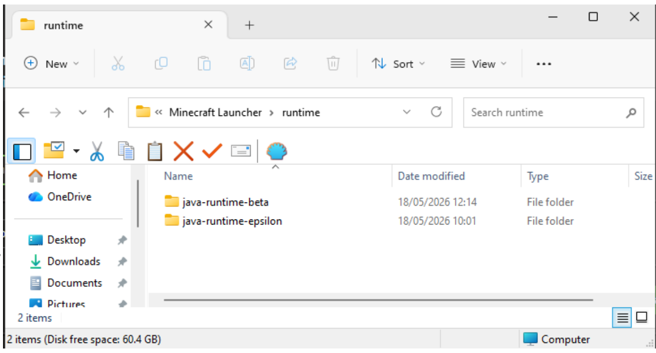
Adding a second instance

You need a different runtime, so use the standard Minecraft Launcher and choose a different version as a new installation: Here I have chosen 1.18



There is no need to run the new install and you can close the official launcher at this point

If you check the runtime folder you will now see a second Java install:



java-runtime-beta

As before, isolate the base folder and copy it to Dropbox/multimc/java/windows

Re-Launch Multi-MC and add a new instance, this time 1.18

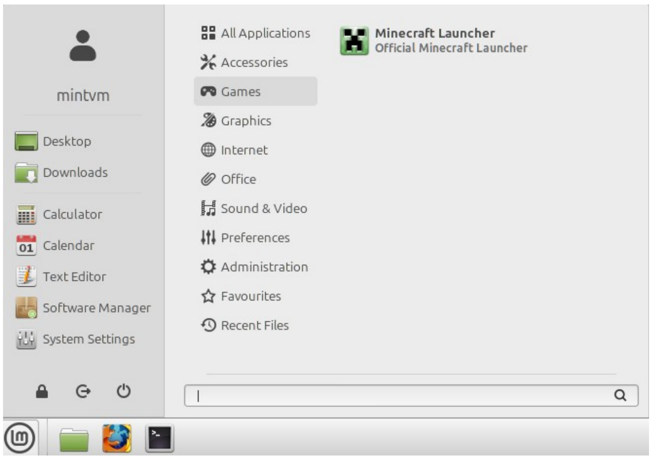
This time, in Edit Instance → settings you will need to set the java path to the version appropriate for that game. (java-runtime-beta for 1.18)

You can now use these two games on any windows machine that has your Dropbox account installed and operational.

Dual boot or separate machine with Linux OS

You will need to have Dropbox installed on the other machine or dual boot partition and logged in with the same account.

The process is similar to windows and is demonstrated on linux Mint.



Follow the steps above on minecraft.net

Downloaded Minecraft.deb as Mint is Debian based.

Installed with Software Manager.
It then appears in the Games folder:

As before login with Microsoft account

Repeat the procedure above for creating a new installation. Un-tick “launch after install”

This time, the runtime is stored in

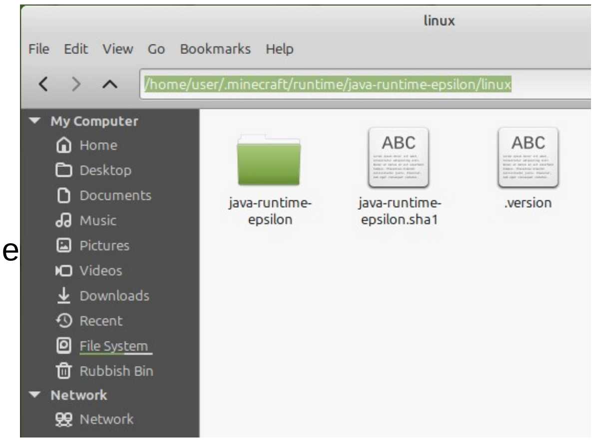
```
/home/user/.minecraft/runtime/<version>/linux/<version>:
```

Use the menu view → show hidden files to see it

Copy the final folder into

`Dropbox/mutimc/java/linux/<version>`
(currently java-runtime-epsilon)

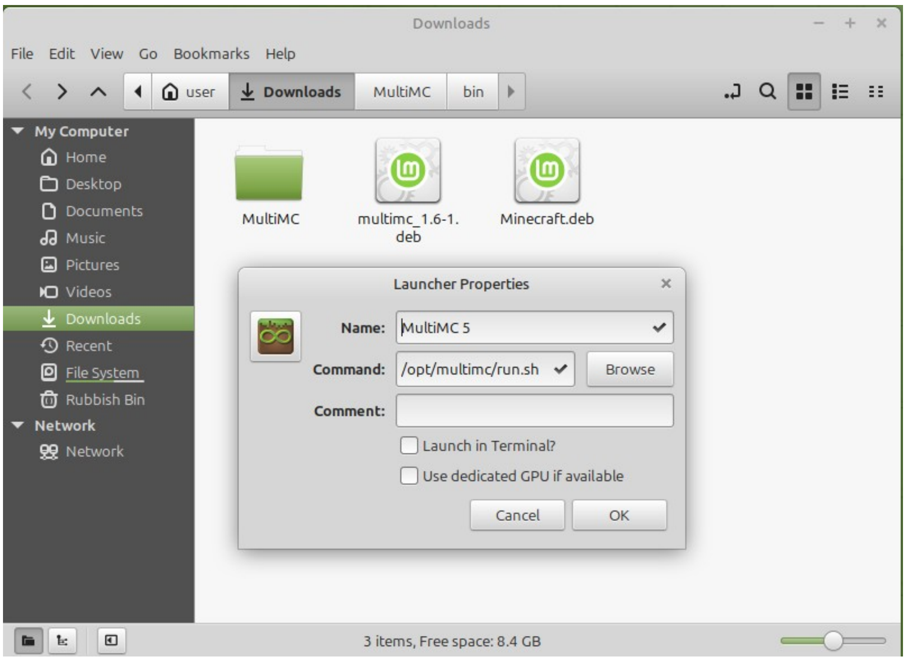
Repeat the process for every game version in the instances folder that was setup on Windows



Setup MultiMC on Linux:

Go to MultiMC website and download the Debian/Ubuntu version. (Currently multimc_1.6-1.deb)

Run with Package Installer.
This will add install to `opt/multimc/` and add a shortcut to the menu system.
The properties of this shortcut are shown on top of the Downloads contents in the screenshot:



The contents of `/opt/multimc/run.sh` are:

```
#!/bin/bash

INSTDIR="${XDG_DATA_HOME-$HOME/.local/share}/multimc"

if [ `getconf LONG_BIT` = "64" ]
then
    PACKAGE="mmc-stable-lin64.tar.gz"
else
    PACKAGE="mmc-stable-lin32.tar.gz"
fi

deploy() {
    mkdir -p $INSTDIR
    cd ${INSTDIR}

    wget --progress=dot:force "https://files.multimc.org/downloads/${PACKAGE}" 2>&1 | sed -u 's/.* \([0-9]\
+%\)\ \+\([0-9.]\+.\) \(.*\)/\1\n# Downloading at \2\/s, ETA \3/' | zenity --progress --auto-close --auto-
kill --title="Downloading MultiMC..."
|
    tar -xzf ${PACKAGE} --transform='s,MultiMC/,,'
    rm ${PACKAGE}
    chmod +x MultiMC
}

runmmc() {
    cd ${INSTDIR}
    ./MultiMC "$@"
}

if [[ ! -f ${INSTDIR}/MultiMC ]]; then
    deploy
    runmmc "$@"
else
    runmmc "$@"
fi
```

The only important part is the install directory in the second line:

`$HOME/.local/share/multimc`

Run the application and it will start from this directory, installing the files to

`HOME/.local/share/multimc.`

It will ask you to confirm the default java path found in your os.

Click Next and finish

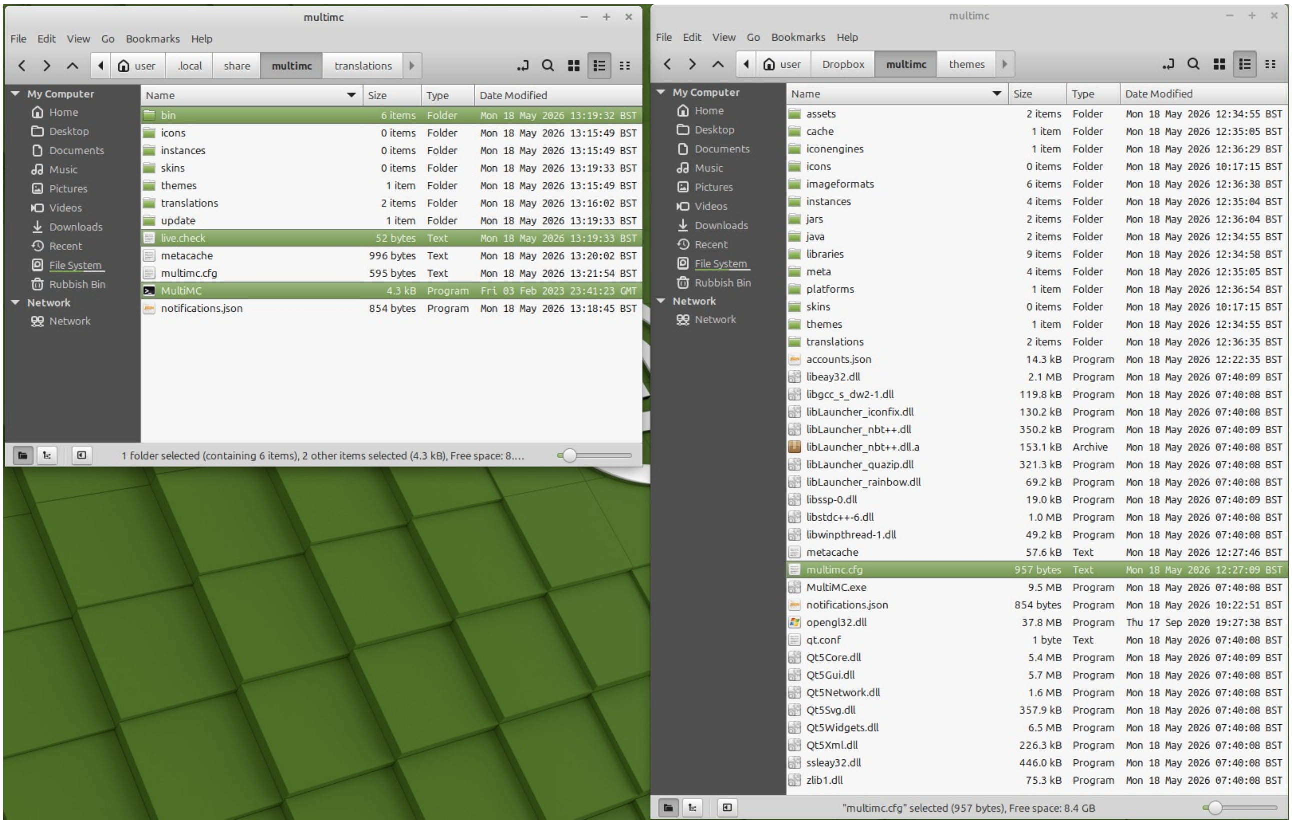
If an update notice pops up go ahead and update

After it has updated, close it down. You will not be running it from this location.

Go to the path above `HOME/.local/share/multimc/`

Delete any .log files

Open the Dropbox/multimc folder in a new file explorer window next to it:



Copy the folders/files highlighted from the install location to Dropbox/multimc

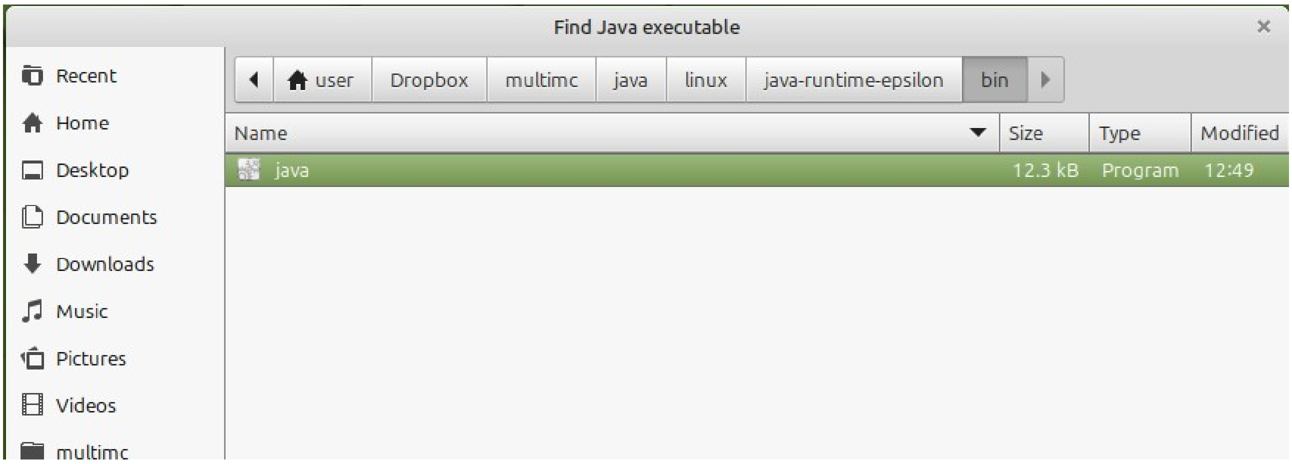
- bin
- live.check (if present)
- MultiMC

Double-click on the file MultiMC in the Dropbox folder.

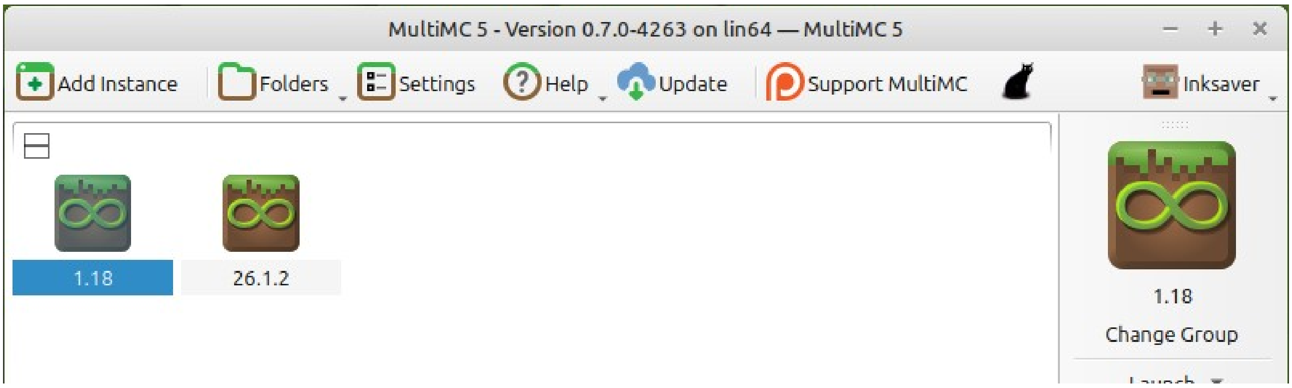
It will run, and asks again for the Java installation.

Click Browse → navigate to

`Dropbox/multimc/java/linux/java-runtime-epsilon/bin/java`



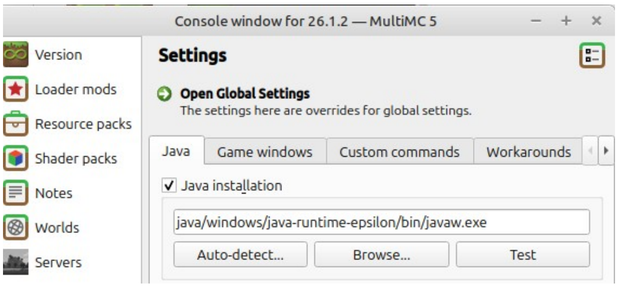
It will now start and show the two games setup in Windows:



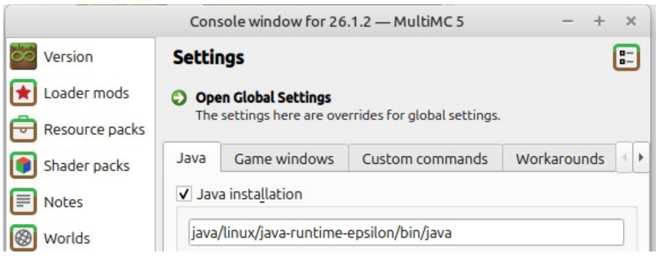
Notice how my Account (Inksaver) is already configured! The tokens and keys are kept in the Dropbox folder and travel with you.

Select one of the games and click the Edit Instance button → Settings

The Windows java edition shows:

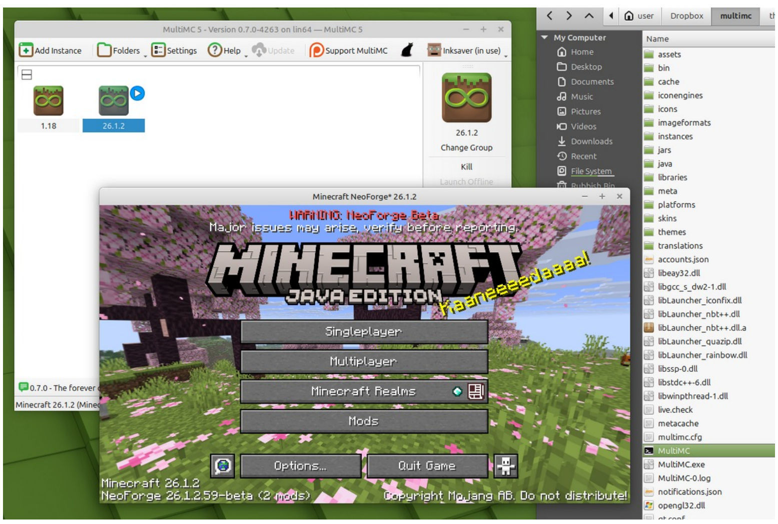


Browse for the Linux version:



Click OK and run the game.

Success. You now have the exact same game, running on different machines and even different operating systems!

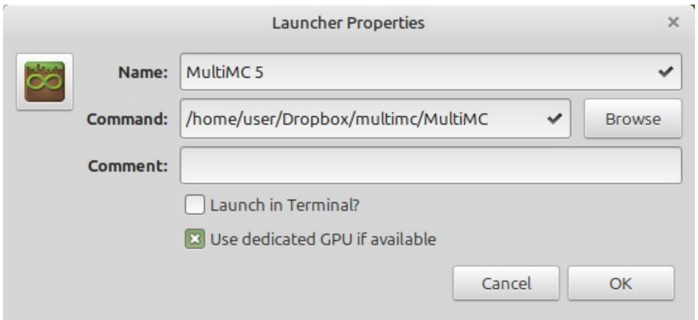


Changing the Linux shortcut:

For convenience, change the shortcut to run from Dropbox instead:

Right-click on the shortcut → properties.
You will see the properties shown on page 7

Click Browse and change the command to `/home/<user>/Dropbox/multimc/MultiMC`



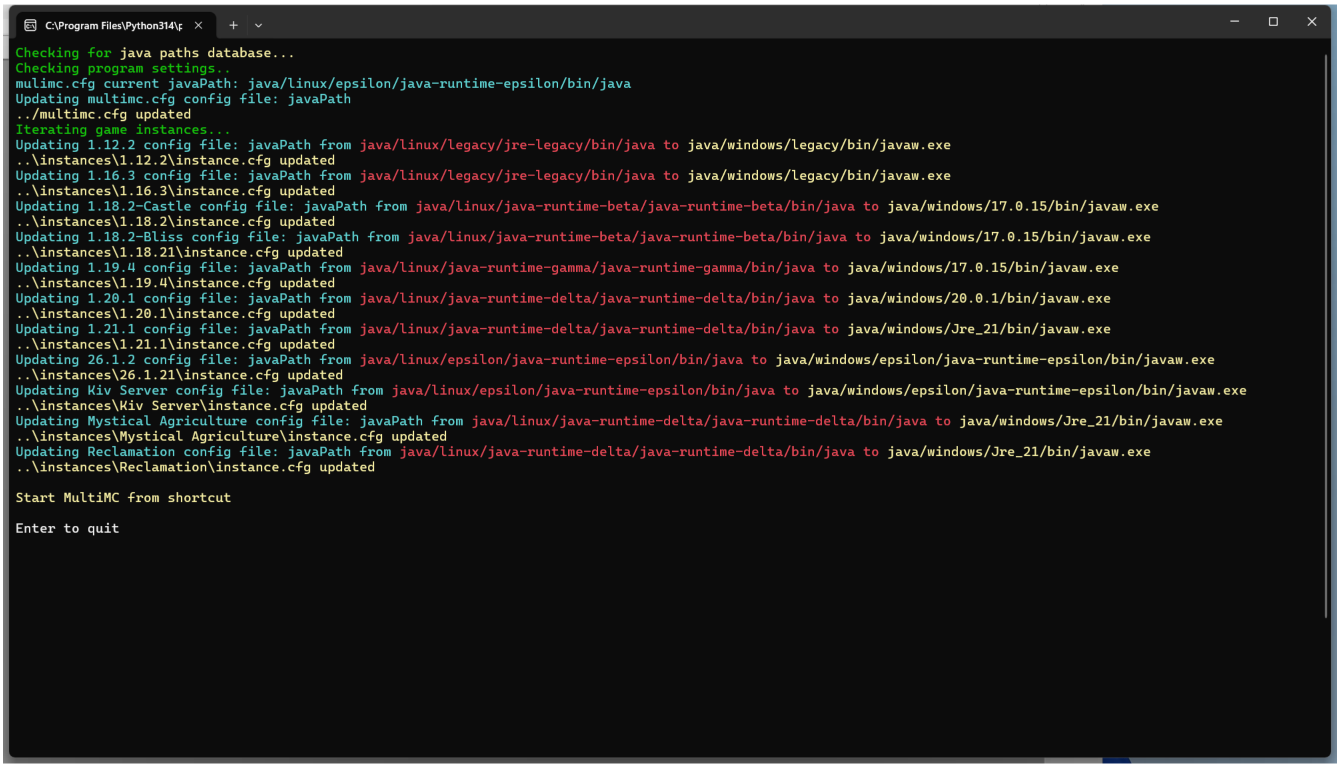
Tick the Use dedicated GPU if available.

Python script to automate config changes

A python script has been created to handle running MultiMC on different OS.

It creates a sqlite3 database to hold the JavaPath of the java versions in multimc/java and the main config file multimc.cfg

It re-writes the config files on all games in the instances folder.
Example after starting on Windows:



Get the 2 script files from https://github.com/Inksaver/MultiMC-on-Cloud

To use this script, create a new folder inside multimc called ConfigSwitcher.
Place the files main.py and database.py into this folder.

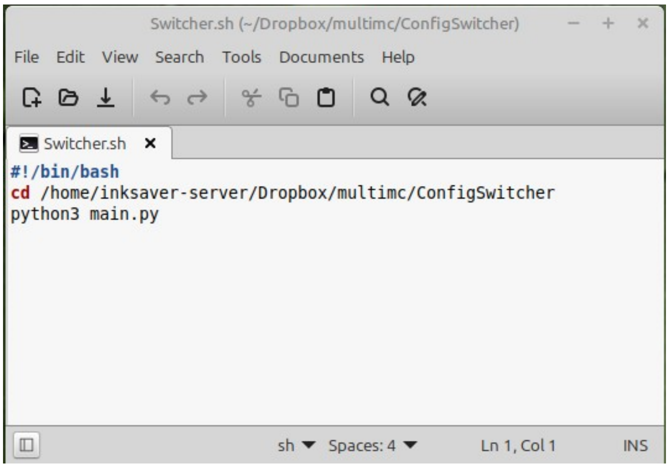
Run main.py in Widows by double-clicking it, or right-click, select Send To Desktop and that will create a shortcut. When double-clicking the shortcut the first time, you may be prompted to select how it should be opened. Select Python and Always.

Setting up a shortcut in Mint is a bit more involved.

- right-click inside the ConfigSwitcher folder → Create new document → empty document.
- name it switcher.sh
- open config.sh with text editor
- add these lines:

```
#!/bin/bash
cd /home/<username>/Dropbox/multimc/ConfigSwitcher
python3 main.py
```

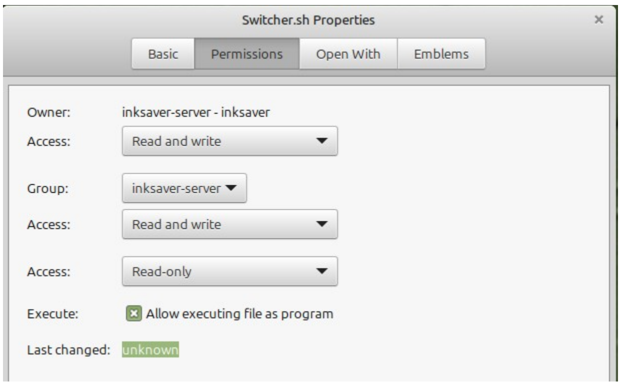
Remember to use your user name!



Right-click on switcher.sh → properties

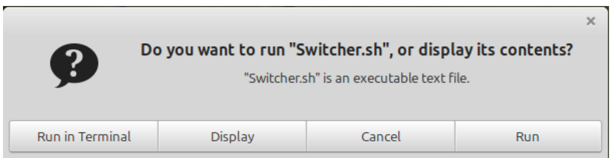
Tick the Execute box

Close properties

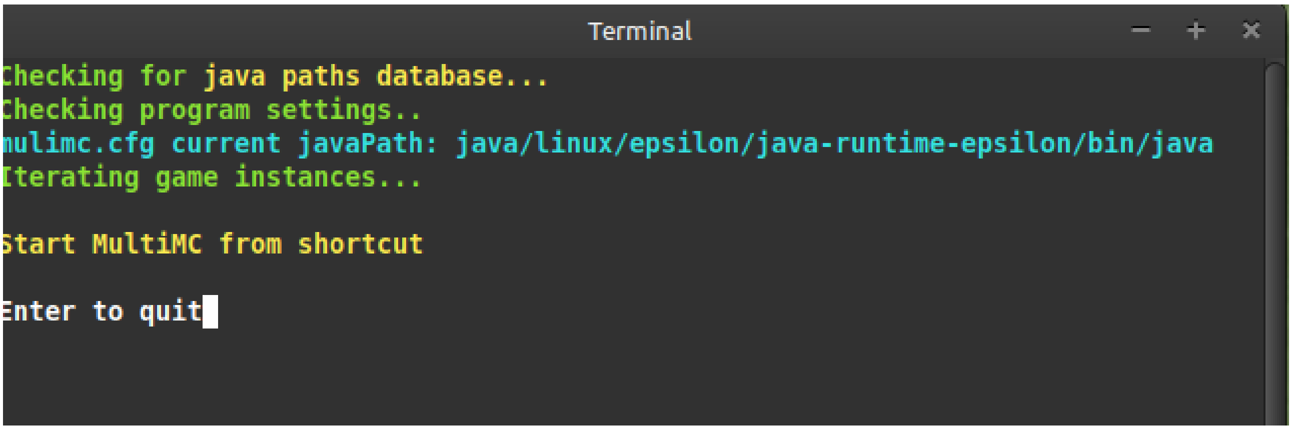


Double-click to test:

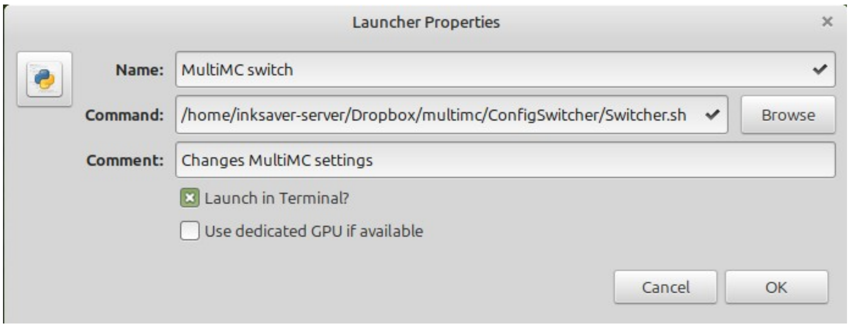
Click Run in Terminal



Success, but the popup is annoying.

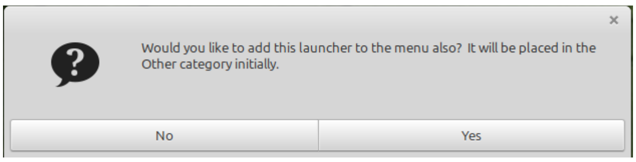


Next step right-click on the desktop → Create new launcher here



1. Click on the icon to change it. Python used here
2. Give it a name
3. Browse for the .sh file you just created
4. Add a comment if you want
5. Check the Launch in terminal box
6. OK

Add to general menu as well



Double-click the launcher. You may have to confirm it is trusted first time.

The python screenshot above confirms everything is correct, so just run MultiMC as usual